

BRAVE NEW PHILADELPHIA — Production

Prep Package

A Futuristamantes Film · Another 3 Hearts Production

Prep package v1 — 2026-05-23. Companion to the treatment and script.

This document is the working set for pre-production, shoot, and post. It covers schedule, crew, location-by-location shot lists, the visualization brief, equipment, access requirements, post-pro pipeline, and the score brief. Pair with `brave-new-philadelphia.md` (script) and `brave-new-philadelphia-treatment.md` (treatment).

At-a-glance

Field	Value
Runtime target	4–6 minutes
Format	Short documentary with architectural visualization
On-camera talent	Harry (six locations + voice-over)
Live action shoot days	3–4 (target: one weekend + one weekday backup)
Post-production window	6–8 weeks
Distribution premiere	Single venue screening, date TBD
Permanent home	futuristamantes.com

Production Schedule

Phase 1 — Pre-Production (4–6 weeks)

Week	Milestone
1	Crew lock (DP, visualization artist, editor, composer, drone operator). Initial location agreements drafted.
2	Location scouts at all six sites. Lighting + timing reference photos collected. Visualization brief finalized per location.
3	Drone permit application filed. Property access agreements signed. Composer scoring brief delivered.
4	

Week	Milestone
	Storyboard pass complete (treatment-level → frame-level). Equipment list locked. Voice-over recording session scheduled.
5	Final shoot schedule. Weather contingency plan. Crew briefing.
6	Buffer week / re-scout if conditions changed.

Phase 2 — Principal Photography (3–4 shoot days)

Day	Block	Locations	Hours
Day 1 (Saturday morning, cold gray)	Opening + walking sequences	North Broad establishing shots, SOUTH, Honeysuckle	5:30 AM – 12 PM
Day 2 (afternoon, same weekend)	Industrial + church	The Garage Building, The Church	1 PM – 6 PM
Day 3 (next morning)	Workforce + processing	Samuel Staten Building, PCA Building	6 AM – 1 PM
Day 4 (weather backup)	Drone finale + pickups	North Broad aerial passes, any pickups	TBD
Studio	Voice-over	Booth	2 hr session, separate day

Phase 3 — Post-Production (6–8 weeks)

Week	Milestone
1	Footage logged + selects pulled. Rough cut v1.
2	Visualization artist receives final cut points + clean plates per location.
3	First-pass transformations delivered for the six locations.
4	Visualization revisions. Sound design begins. Composer drafts first cue.
5	Picture lock candidate. Score recording.
6	Final mix. Color grade.
7	Final master. PDF stills + thumbnail capture for promotion.
8	Delivery: master files, web encodes, distribution package.

Crew Manifest (minimum viable)

Role	Day rate range (placeholder)	Responsibility
Director / DP	—	Camera operation, framing, walking-camera handheld discipline. Sets the visual register.
Camera AC	—	Pulls focus, swaps lenses, manages cards on location.
Drone operator	—	Single day for aerial work. Permitted, insured, certified for the airspace.
Sound recordist	—	Diegetic city sounds on location (essential for the opening minute). Lavalier on Harry for any live dialogue captured.
Visualization artist	—	Architectural compositing for each transformation. Reference: rendering / VFX integration, NOT generative-AI maximalism.
Editor	—	Picture cut, pacing, integration of VFX into live action.
Composer	—	Original score. Minimal, cinematic.
Voice-over engineer	—	Clean V.O. capture in booth.
Producer / coordinator	—	Schedule, permits, location agreements, talent coordination, deliverables tracking.

Note. Roles can compress (DP doubles as director; editor handles initial sound; composer recorded in-box). Minimum on the day-of-shoot: DP, AC, sound recordist, talent. Drone operator and visualization artist work separately.

Location-by-Location Shot Lists

Format: each location gets a list of **live action shots** to capture and **VFX coverage** to capture clean (for the visualization artist's compositing work).

Location 0 — Opening Establishing (Pre-titles)

Address. North Broad Street, vicinity of opening walk. Multiple establishing locations along the corridor.

Time of day. Cold gray morning. Pre-rush hour (5:30–7:00 AM). Ambient light only — no fill, no sun.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
0.1	Black screen with city sound bed	Sound only — SEPTA brakes, distant sirens, wind, construction, basketball
0.2	Tight on empty lot, slow push-in	Cold gray sky in frame top, vacant ground below
0.3	Traffic flow at intersection, locked-off mid	Standard speed, no slow-motion
0.4	Vacant storefront facade, slight angle	Roll-down gate, peeling paint, real texture
0.5	People waiting at SEPTA stop, candid wide	Capture as documentary, no direction
0.6	Harry walking alone (full body, behind)	Slow push-in. Steady handheld. He walks at natural pace, no acting.
0.7	Harry walking alone (3/4 from side)	Match pace from 0.6. Profile against vacant storefront.

VFX coverage. None — opening sequence is unaltered Philadelphia.

Sound priorities. This is the only sequence with no music. Sound design carries it. Boom + dual lav for ambient depth.

Location 1 — SOUTH Restaurant

Address. SOUTH Restaurant (1850 N. Broad St., Philadelphia — confirm during scout)

Time of day. Same morning as opening (continuity). After 0.7 walking shot, Harry continues into this sequence.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
1.1	Harry approaching SOUTH, exterior wide	Full building in frame. Hold for 4 sec — gives compositor a stable plate.
1.2	Harry gestures toward building	Subtle gesture, NOT theatrical. Could be a half-turn + an arm raise.
1.3	Tighter on Harry's face, looking up	Brief reaction — interior emotional beat.
1.4	Clean plate of SOUTH exterior, no Harry	Static, locked-off, 10+ seconds. Multiple angles.
1.5	Side angle of SOUTH building, full	Helps with the 3D understanding for compositor.

#	Shot	Notes
1.6	Interior atmosphere shot (if access)	Ambient — establishes the dining environment.

VFX coverage (clean plates for compositor).

- Multiple angles of the exterior at the same lighting condition
- 4K+ resolution, ideally RAW or high-bitrate codec
- Reference scale marker if possible (a person walking through frame as height reference)
- Architectural detail shots: roofline, window grid, entrance proportions

Live action audio. Harry's voice-over recorded separately in booth. On location: ambient + Harry's footsteps + any incidental sound.

Location 2 — Honeysuckle

Address. Honeysuckle Provisions (Confirm during scout — current location near SOUTH on N. Broad)

Time of day. Late morning. Light may have shifted; aim for similar gray quality.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
2.1	Harry walking past Honeysuckle, exterior wide	Mirror the SOUTH approach pattern
2.2	Building wide, locked-off, no talent	Clean plate, 10+ sec
2.3	Detail shots — facade, signage, neighborhood texture	For compositor reference
2.4	Wider street context with Honeysuckle in mid-ground	Establishes neighborhood gathering character

VFX coverage.

- Same protocol: clean plate, scale reference, multiple angles
- Adjacent buildings/sidewalk in frame (the script calls for "the entire corridor slowly begins changing" — compositor may extend transformation beyond Honeysuckle itself)

Location 3 — The Garage Building

Address. TBD during scout — an industrial garage structure along the corridor, dark and visually industrial.

Time of day. Mid-day, harder light. The script calls for "Dark. Industrial." — schedule shoot when contrast is highest.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
3.1	Wide exterior, Harry walking past	Slow tracking shot
3.2	Push-in on building entrance	Industrial doors, garage bay
3.3	Clean plate, exterior locked-off	10+ sec
3.4	Interior establishing (if access)	Currently empty / industrial — sets the "before" baseline for the transformation
3.5	Workers (extras or real) walking through space	If accessible — establishes scale

VFX coverage.

- Multiple exterior angles for compositing
- Interior plates of the empty/industrial state (the transformation fills it with vertical farming + robotics + clean glowing production spaces)
- Architectural detail: rooflines, structural supports, ventilation infrastructure

Location 4 — The Church

Address. TBD during scout — a church along the corridor with photographable interior access. Requires partnership with congregation.

Time of day. Interior shoot. Late afternoon for stained-glass color saturation.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
4.1	Exterior wide of church	Establishes location
4.2	Harry approaches, stops at door	Beat. Stillness. Music drops.
4.3	Doors begin to open	Slow, intentional
4.4	Interior: nave, currently empty, wide	The "before" frame — sets up the transformation
4.5	Stained glass — detail	For color/light reference in compositor work
4.6	Pews / aisle / altar — context shots	Helps the compositor understand the space
4.7	Light passing through stained glass onto floor	Atmospheric — establishes the closing image of "stained glass glows over shared meals"

VFX coverage.

- Interior plates of empty nave from multiple angles (the transformation will populate it with communal tables, families, fresh food)
 - The treatment specifies: "NOT charity imagery. Beauty. Humanity. Community." — visualization brief must reflect this. See visualization section below.
 - Reference for compositor: real communal dining imagery, dignity-coded — NOT food bank reference
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Location 5 — Samuel Staten Building

Address. Samuel Staten, Sr. Center (Confirm — likely a labor / training building along the corridor)

Time of day. Mid-morning. Indoor + exterior balance.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
5.1	Exterior wide, Harry walking	Continuity with the walk pattern
5.2	Clean exterior plate	10+ sec
5.3	Interior establishing (if access)	The transformation fills it with workforce training, robotics labs, culinary incubation, logistics command — the empty/ current state is the baseline
5.4	Detail shots — facade signage, building identity	Helps the audience locate it

VFX coverage.

- Exterior plates: multiple angles for compositing
 - Interior plates: the rooms that will be transformed (training labs, robotics workspace, culinary incubation kitchen)
 - Architectural: rooflines, window grid, scale of the building relative to surrounding context
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Location 6 — PCA Building / Food Processing Hub

Address. PCA Building (Confirm — Philadelphia industrial building suitable for transformation into a processing hub)

Time of day. Mid-day or early afternoon.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
6.1	Exterior wide	Building in context
6.2	Harry walking past, with view of building beyond	Continuity walk shot
6.3	Clean plate, exterior	10+ sec, locked-off
6.4	Interior: empty industrial space (if access)	Sets the baseline for the processing-hub transformation
6.5	Detail: loading dock, freight access, scale of operation	Adds production-realism context

VFX coverage.

- Exterior plates: full building, multiple angles
- Interior plates: empty industrial floor (the transformation fills with packaging machines, sauce production, prepared meals, microgreens, mushrooms, plant proteins — and labels reading "Grown in Philadelphia / Exporting from Philadelphia")
- Loading dock for the export beat of the visual sequence

Location 7 — North Broad Drone Finale

Address. Drone passes over the full North Broad Street corridor from north of Temple to south of Center City. Requires FAA Part 107 + city/airspace coordination + drone operator with applicable airspace clearance.

Time of day. Late afternoon golden hour OR overcast for consistency with ground footage. Visualization artist needs to specify which after seeing ground plates.

Live action shots.

#	Shot	Notes
7.1	High wide of corridor, slow track north-to-south	Establishes the spine of the city
7.2	Slower ascent over a specific block	Sets up the "transformed corridor" reveal
7.3	Rising shot from low altitude to high altitude	Final sweeping image — corridor below, city beyond
7.4	Multiple passes of each transformation location from above	Compositor needs aerial perspective on each building to render the corridor-scale transformation cohesively
7.5	Final rise above Philadelphia skyline	Music swells. Corridor visible as green artery cutting through the city.

VFX coverage.

- All drone passes captured clean (no talent, no overlays)
 - High enough resolution that compositor can paint in: greenhouses, public markets, plant-based cafes, hydroponics, community kitchens, public dining spaces
 - The transformation here is the largest scope — the entire corridor changes. Plan for significant post-pro time on this sequence.
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Visualization Brief

This is the design brief for the compositor / visualization artist. Each location has a "before" state (live action) and a "transformed" state (composited). The brief describes the transformed state per location, with design language and constraints.

Universal design principles

1. **Architectural realism.** Every transformation must look like it could be designed and built by a real architect. Respect rooflines, structural columns, materiality, scale.
2. **No sci-fi.** No floating panels, no glowing-blue holograms, no future-tech tropes. The reference language is *contemporary architecture and built-environment renderings* — think IDEO, Studio Gang, BIG, contemporary food-systems architecture.
3. **Light continues.** The compositor should match the lighting of the live action plate. Cold gray morning on the plate → cold gray morning on the transformed elements.
4. **Materiality.** Glass, steel, plant matter, warm wood, soft fabric. Not chrome, not neon, not plastic gloss.
5. **People belong.** Transformed spaces should include people — chefs harvesting, families dining, workers operating cultivation systems. Composite real people into the scene, scaled correctly.
6. **No charity coding.** Especially in the church sequence. Communal meals are framed as dignity and abundance, not as relief or service.

Per-location transformation briefs

SOUTH Restaurant (Location 1)

- **Adds:** rooftop greenhouse structure (glass + light steel, fitting current building footprint), vertical hydroponic towers on side wall, edible wall as exterior accent, courtyard cultivation if there's adjacent space, chefs harvesting produce visible through windows
- **Keeps:** the building's existing facade, signage, street presence
- **People:** chefs in motion, diners visible inside
- **Tone:** elegant, restaurant-grade, NOT industrial

Honeysuckle (Location 2)

- **Adds:** rooftop farming structure, glass cultivation structures visible street-level, community greenhouse spaces adjacent, neighborhood gathering activity outside (people, market activity)

- **Keeps:** the storefront, the neighborhood texture
- **People:** neighborhood crowd, community gathering energy
- **Tone:** warm, community-coded

The Garage Building (Location 3)

- **Adds:** indoor vertical farming system filling the interior bays, robotics moving through racks, food science lab elements (clean glass panels, plant racks), workers in clean uniforms moving efficiently
- **Keeps:** the industrial exterior shell, the existing structural columns
- **People:** workers in motion (suggested 3–5 visible at once)
- **Tone:** clean, technical, industrial-but-precise. The transformation is "industrial reborn" — the building stays industrial in feel, but the activity inside is precision food production

The Church (Location 4)

- **Adds:** long communal tables filling the nave, families seated together eating fresh food, warm pendant lighting overhead, fresh-food platters on tables, stained glass casting color onto the scene
- **Keeps:** the church architecture, the stained glass, the structural beauty of the interior
- **People:** multi-generational families. Variety. Eating, talking, smiling. NOT serving lines, NOT plastic trays.
- **Tone:** dignity, beauty, community. The most important visualization to get right — the script's thesis line lands here ("Food is not charity. Food is infrastructure.")

Samuel Staten Building (Location 5)

- **Adds:** workforce training spaces (robotics labs, culinary incubation kitchens, greenhouse certifications signage, logistics command center with monitors), young Philadelphians learning, instructors guiding
- **Keeps:** the building's institutional character
- **People:** trainees and instructors, age-diverse, race-diverse (reflecting Philadelphia)
- **Tone:** active, focused, hopeful. The visual is "education that leads to work"

PCA Building (Location 6)

- **Adds:** packaging machines, sauce production lines, prepared meal assembly, microgreens production, mushrooms in racks, plant-protein production, prominent labels visible reading "GROWN IN PHILADELPHIA" and "EXPORTING FROM PHILADELPHIA"
- **Keeps:** the industrial footprint, loading dock, freight scale
- **People:** workers moving through the operation, plus visible products and labels
- **Tone:** real food production at scale — proud, clean, operational

North Broad Drone Finale (Location 7)

- **Adds:** the entire corridor transforms — greenhouses on rooftops, public markets at street level, plant-based cafes, artists painting murals, kids learning in visible courtyards, hydroponics towers, community kitchens, live music vignettes, public dining spaces

- **Keeps:** the corridor's spine, the city's recognizable skyline beyond
 - **People:** street-level activity visible from drone height
 - **Tone:** alive. The corridor glows green and the city is whole. This is the film's emotional peak; the visualization must deliver.
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Equipment List

Camera & lens

- Primary: 1× full-frame cinema camera (RED, ARRI, or Sony FX — preference based on DP)
- Lenses: 24mm + 35mm + 50mm + 85mm primes for the walk + transformations; 24-70mm zoom for flexibility
- Filters: ND set for the brighter mid-day exteriors

Camera support

- Handheld rig (DP-preferred) — opening sequence requires controlled handheld
- Lightweight tripod for locked-off clean plates
- Small slider for subtle push-ins where needed

Drone

- Sub-1 lb cinema drone with 4K+ camera OR DJI Inspire 3 (operator preference)
- Spare batteries (6+) for the corridor passes
- FAA Part 107 certified operator + airspace clearance documented

Sound

- Boom + lavalier (Sennheiser MKH 416 + lav set)
- Field recorder (Sound Devices MixPre-3 or similar)
- Headphones for monitoring

Lighting

- Minimal — natural light is the visual register
- Possible: 1× small LED panel for fill in the interior church + interior building shots
- Reflector kit

Data + power

- Cards: 4× 256GB or larger (high-bitrate)
 - Backup drives: 2× 4TB SSD on location
 - Power: spare batteries for all devices
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Permits & Access Requirements

Need	Owner	Status
FAA Part 107 + airspace clearance for drone	Producer	File at least 30 days pre-shoot
City film permit (if required for street filming)	Producer	Check Philadelphia Film Office requirements
Property access — SOUTH	Producer + owner agreement	Filming agreement + insurance certificate
Property access — Honeysuckle	Producer + owner agreement	Same
Property access — Garage Building	Producer + owner agreement	Same; interior access if possible
Property access — Church	Producer + congregation	Particular care needed — partnership tone, not transactional
Property access — Samuel Staten Building	Producer + institutional contact	Workforce-relevance framing helps the ask
Property access — PCA Building	Producer + owner agreement	Standard filming agreement
Insurance	Producer	General liability + equipment + drone-specific
Talent release — Harry	Producer	Standard release form
Talent release — any extras / passersby in frame	Producer	Release for identifiable extras; signage notice for public area filming

Post-Production Pipeline

Picture

1. Footage ingested and backed up (3-2-1 rule: 3 copies, 2 media types, 1 offsite)
2. Selects pulled from each location
3. Rough cut against the script + voice-over scratch
4. Clean plates pulled per location and delivered to visualization artist
5. First-pass transformations integrated into rough cut
6. Revisions
7. Picture lock candidate

8. Color grade
9. Final master

Sound

1. Field recordings logged
2. Dialogue / V.O. cleaned and ADR if needed
3. Sound design (especially the opening minute — city sound bed must do the work)
4. Composer's score integrated
5. Final mix (stereo + 5.1)

Score

See score brief below.

Deliverables

- 4K ProRes master
- 1080p H.264 web encode
- 720p H.264 web encode (low-bandwidth fallback)
- Embedded captions / SRT file
- Promotional stills (10+ frame captures from key sequences)
- Trailer / teaser (30–60 sec)
- Poster / key art (separate visual design pass)

Score Brief (for composer)

Brief

A short documentary about Philadelphia's possible future. The film opens silent, in cold morning light. A man walks alone down North Broad Street. Then he asks: *what if the best version of Philadelphia hasn't happened yet?* And the music begins.

The score is the film's emotional climate — restrained, hopeful, civic. Not orchestral swell. Not corporate. Not minimalist-cold. The reference language is contemporary documentary score with serious civic weight: Jóhann Jóhannsson's *Last and First Men*, Hildur Guðnadóttir's *Joker* restraint (not the menace, the restraint), early Nils Frahm.

Specifics

Beat	Cue	Direction
Cold open	NO MUSIC	Sound design only — the city's own voice. 45–60 sec.
Title card lands	Cue 1 enters	

Beat	Cue	Direction
		Single sustained note. Builds slowly. Sparse piano + bowed strings.
Walk to SOUTH	Cue 1 continues	Sustained, doesn't pull focus from V.O.
Building transformations begin	Cue 2	Adds shimmer, harmonic motion. Still restrained. Reverberant.
The Church	Cue 3 — drop	Music drops to near silence. One sustained note. Lets the visual carry.
"Food is not charity" line	Cue 3 swells slightly	Subtle re-emergence. Bowed strings.
Workforce + processing sequences	Cue 4	Steady forward motion. Pulse without drum.
Drone finale	Cue 5 — swell	Music finally swells. Strings build, piano figures, a sense of arrival.
Final voice-over	Cue 5 continues to fade	Slow decay as voice-over closes.
Final card	Single note + silence	Lands the title.

Technical

- Stereo + 5.1 stems
- Tempo flexibility — score will be revised to picture lock; deliverables marked to final cut points
- All cues original composition. No needle-drop.
- Score length total: ~3.5–5 minutes (full film runtime is 4–6 min including the silent opening)

Open production decisions (require Ian / Harry direction)

Decision	Notes
Director / DP confirmation	Who is operating the camera. Sets the visual register decisively.
Visualization artist confirmation	Critical for the architectural realism — the wrong choice undoes the whole conceit.
Composer confirmation	Tone is specific; reference brief above.
Voice-over recording venue	Booth booked; date set.
Shoot dates (target weekend)	Weather window matters — cold gray morning is integral.

Decision	Notes
Premiere venue	Drives the post-production back-schedule.
Budget envelope	Confirms crew/equipment/visualization scope.

Document status

- **Production prep v1** — 2026-05-23. First complete prep package.
- **Pairs with.** brave-new-philadelphia.md (script) + brave-new-philadelphia-treatment.md (treatment).
- **Next revision trigger.** Crew lock or first scout pass.